

# The flowing current

From foamy white, cascading torrents to slow but ever-moving waters, rivers provide a rich habitat for a wide variety of wildlife.

## The food chain begins

As leaves and dead animals fall into the waters, bacteria multiply. This brings food for aquatic larvae such as the caddisfly.

Caddisfly larva



## From small beginnings

Many rivers start life as fast-flowing streams. It is often a barren beginning, but plants and animals soon thrive.



Caddisfly



Mosses often grow on riverside rocks and trees and provide shelter for many tiny bugs that need damp conditions.

## Stop that water!

Beavers sometimes build dams to create lakes, slowing the flow of water and so changing their habitat. They also create lodges to live in.

Beaver

Fallen trees can provide pathways for animals and insects to cross a fast-flowing stream.



Which is the world's longest river?